You will learn about another option to store your data in the next chapter: a network filesystem.

Summary

- Block-level storage can be used only in combination with an EC2 instance because the OS is needed to provide access to the block-level storage (including partitions, filesystems, and read/write system calls).
- When creating an EBS volume, you need to specify the volume size. AWS charges you for the provisioned storage, no matter whether or not you are using all the storage. Also, it is possible to increase the size of a volume later.
- EBS volumes are connected to a single EC2 instance via network. Depending on your instance type, this network connection can use more or less bandwidth.
- There are different types of EBS volumes available: General Purpose SSD (gp3), Provisioned IOPS SSD (io2), Throughput Optimized HDD (st1), and Cold HDD (sc1) are the most common.
- EBS snapshots are a powerful way to back up your EBS volumes because they use a block-level, incremental approach.
- An instance store provides low latency and high throughput. However, as you are using storage directly attached to the physical machine running your virtual machine, data is lost if you stop or terminate the instance.
- Typically, an instance store is used only for temporary data that does not need to be persisted.